

Agentic AI Daily Digest — Wednesday, 24 June 2026

TL;DR * Five9 launches Voice AI Agents, but their seat-based model remains vulnerable to AI deflection, and their AI is a bolt-on over a legacy platform. * Salesforce Agentforce secures new customer wins, yet its pricing unpredictability and platform lock-in persist as key concerns. * Glean and ServiceNow expand AI agent partnerships, reinforcing their internal/ITSM focus rather than external customer experience. * Sierra and Parloa continue to build brand and thought leadership, but both notably lack independent, CX-specific analyst validation. * IBM partners with Google Cloud for AI agent deployment, despite its recent slip to Gartner Challenger status and reported platform overlaps.

Undercut Opportunities

Five9 — Launches Voice AI Agents to replace IVRs — (2026-06-23) [Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Pricing/TCO; Proof/validation gap; Other (platform architecture)
- **Angle:** Five9's new Voice AI Agents, while a step forward, are built on a legacy seat-based CCaaS model structurally exposed to AI deflection. Their AI is a bolt-on, not a native, governed agentic platform, leading to potential unpredictability and lack of enterprise-grade determinism. Forrester also rates them a "Strong Performer," not a "Leader," in CCaaS.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai's ABL provides compile-time validation and deterministic execution for critical paths, ensuring governance and auditability, unlike bolt-on AI. Our platform is designed for cost-per-outcome economics, not seat-based models vulnerable to AI's success. Kore.ai is a Leader in Gartner MQ Conversational AI 2025 and Forrester Wave: Conversational AI for Customer Service Q2 2026.
- **Plays: Sales:** "As AI deflection grows, what happens to your committed seat spend — can you model cost-per-resolution two years out?" "Forrester rated Five9 a Strong Performer with enterprise WFM scalability gaps — what containment are you getting in production today?" **PMM:** Content contrasting "bolt-on AI on legacy CCaaS" vs. "AI-native agentic platform"; case studies on predictable cost-per-resolution. **AR:** Emphasize Kore.ai's Leader status in CX-specific conversational AI MQs/Waves, highlighting the architectural difference for determinism and cost predictability. **Product:** Continue to highlight ABL's compile-time validation and deterministic execution as a core advantage for enterprise-grade AI agents.

Glean — Partners with TinyFish for AI agents on live web data; recognized as Gartner "Market Shaper" — (2026-06-24) [Pluang](#), (2026-06-22) [Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Channel/coverage gap; Proof/validation gap
- **Angle:** Glean's new partnerships and analyst recognition, while positive for their internal enterprise search and knowledge management, reinforce their core focus on *employee-facing* AI. They remain absent from CX/contact-center specific analyst evaluations, indicating a lack of true customer-facing omnichannel capabilities.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai is purpose-built for external CX, offering true omnichannel (voice and digital) capabilities, and is recognized as a Leader in six independent analyst evaluations specifically for conversational AI in customer service.
- **Plays: Sales:** "Does Glean handle customer-facing voice and omnichannel, or internal employee search?" "Which CX analyst evaluation names Glean for customer service?" **PMM:** Create content highlighting the difference between internal knowledge/work AI and external customer experience AI.

AR: Emphasize Kore.ai's CX-specific Leader placements and Glean's absence from these, framing Glean as a horizontal internal tool. **Product:** Continue to build out external CX-specific features and integrations, reinforcing our core market.

Sierra — Featured in Forbes AI 50 List; platform review published — [\(2026-06-23\) Forbes](#), [\(2026-06-23\) Cybernews](#)

- **Lever:** Proof/validation gap
- **Angle:** While Sierra benefits from strong brand recognition and media attention, including a Forbes AI 50 listing, this hype still outruns independent CX analyst validation. They are not a Leader in the CX-specific conversational AI evaluations where Kore.ai is.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai is a Leader in Gartner Magic Quadrant for Conversational AI Platforms 2025 and Forrester Wave: Conversational AI for Customer Service Q2 2026, providing objective, third-party validation of our enterprise CX capabilities.
- **Plays: Sales:** "Which independent analyst evaluations name Sierra a Leader for customer service?" **PMM:** Create comparison content highlighting Kore.ai's analyst Leader status vs. Sierra's general AI recognition. **AR:** Proactively brief analysts on Sierra's market presence vs. their actual placement in CX-specific reports, reinforcing Kore.ai's leadership. **Product:** N/A (this is a marketing/AR play).

Parloa — Publishes "Consumer Patience Index" highlighting automation risks — [\(2026-06-22\) PR Newswire](#)

- **Lever:** Proof/validation gap; Channel/coverage gap
- **Angle:** Parloa is attempting to establish thought leadership with its Consumer Patience Index, but this self-published research does not substitute for independent analyst validation. They remain un-evaluated by major CX-specific MQs/Waves and have a limited geographic footprint.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai's leadership is validated by six independent analyst evaluations, including Gartner and Forrester, confirming our global enterprise readiness and comprehensive platform capabilities across all channels.
- **Plays: Sales:** "Which independent analysts have evaluated their platform for enterprise CX?" "How many verified enterprise references do they have outside their home region?" **PMM:** Position Kore.ai's analyst validation as the true measure of enterprise readiness, contrasting it with vendor-published studies. **AR:** Highlight Parloa's absence from key CX analyst reports, emphasizing Kore.ai's broad recognition. **Product:** N/A.

Agentforce (Salesforce) — VCARB and Petty Products deploy Agentforce for fan engagement and revenue management — [\(2026-06-23\) CX Today](#), [\(2026-06-23\) Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Pricing/TCO; Other (platform lock-in); Proof/validation gap
- **Angle:** While Agentforce is securing customer wins, its complex and frequently reworked pricing model (Flex Credits, per-user SKUs) creates significant TCO unpredictability, especially for high-volume, continuous interactions. Furthermore, Agentforce is not a Leader in conversational AI for customer service, and its Data Cloud prerequisite creates platform lock-in.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai offers transparent, predictable pricing models aligned with business outcomes. Our platform is model-agnostic and integrates seamlessly with existing enterprise systems, avoiding vendor lock-in, and we are a Leader in CX-specific conversational AI.
- **Plays: Sales:** "Which pricing model are you on, and can you forecast cost as autonomous agents drive continuous high-volume interactions?" "For voice, whose telephony/WFM/QM are you relying on

— and which analyst names Agentforce a Leader for *customer service conversational AI*?" **PMM:** Develop content on "The True Cost of Agentforce" vs. Kore.ai's predictable pricing; highlight Kore.ai's open platform approach. **AR:** Emphasize Agentforce's pricing complexity and lack of Leader status in conversational AI for CX. **Product:** Ensure our pricing models remain clear and predictable, and continue to enhance our open integration strategy.

ServiceNow Agent Platform — Cognizant integrates ServiceNow AI Agents; Nametag partners for helpdesk security — [\(2026-06-23\) Yahoo Finance](#), [\(2026-06-23\) Business Wire](#)

- **Lever:** Pricing/TCO; Channel/coverage gap; Other (ITSM-centric lock-in)
- **Angle:** ServiceNow's expanding partnerships for AI agents, while increasing ecosystem breadth, further highlight their "assists" consumption model's TCO unpredictability and their continued focus on *internal helpdesk* and ITSM workflows rather than external customer-facing voice and omnichannel CX. Custom AI agents are also gated to their top-tier Prime SKU.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai provides a purpose-built, full-scope omnichannel platform for external CX with predictable pricing. Our ABL enables deterministic, auditable agents for critical customer interactions, not just internal IT tasks.
- **Plays: Sales:** "How do you forecast 'assists' when agentic actions cost 6× a simple task and retry loops burn credits?" "For customer voice, whose telephony are you integrating — and is your CX agent ITSM-workflow-bound or a standalone omnichannel platform?" **PMM:** Develop content contrasting "internal helpdesk AI" vs. "external customer experience AI"; highlight Kore.ai's native voice and omnichannel capabilities. **AR:** Emphasize ServiceNow's ITSM heritage and "assists" pricing challenges for external CX use cases. **Product:** Continue to differentiate our native voice and omnichannel capabilities for external CX, ensuring seamless integration with various CCaaS/telephony providers.

IBM Agent Platform — Publishes thought leadership on agentic orchestration; partners with Google Cloud for AI agent deployment — [\(2026-06-23\) IBM](#), [\(2026-06-22\) theaisoftwarereport.com](#)

- **Lever:** Proof/validation gap; Pricing/TCO; Other (complexity/overlap)
- **Angle:** IBM is actively positioning itself in agentic orchestration and expanding deployment capabilities through partnerships. However, they recently slipped to a Gartner Challenger in Conversational AI, and buyers continue to face confusion due to overlaps between watsonx Orchestrate and watsonx Assistant, leading to increased complexity and consulting dependency. Their RU/token consumption model also creates TCO unpredictability.
- **Kore.ai counter:** Kore.ai provides a unified, clear platform for enterprise conversational AI, recognized as a Gartner Leader. Our ABL simplifies agent development and ensures predictable, auditable performance without the need for extensive consulting or navigating overlapping products.
- **Plays: Sales:** "Are you on watsonx Orchestrate or watsonx Assistant for customer-facing conversational AI — and why did Gartner move IBM to Challenger?" "How do you forecast RU/token spend for high-volume CX?" **PMM:** Content contrasting IBM's "complexity and overlap" with Kore.ai's "unified, Leader-recognized platform." **AR:** Highlight IBM's Gartner Challenger status and the reported confusion between their offerings. **Product:** Maintain a clear, unified product roadmap for our agentic platform, avoiding internal overlaps.

Top Stories

Five9 Launches Voice AI Agents for Next-Gen Self-Service Five9 has unveiled a new release of Voice AI Agents designed to power agentic self-service and replace traditional IVRs in contact centers. This move aims to enhance customer experience through more intelligent and autonomous voice interactions. The launch is highlighted across multiple publications, signaling a significant push into advanced AI agent capabilities. **Why it matters:** This is a direct challenge in the core agentic AI space. While Five9 is a major CCaaS player, their historical seat-based pricing model and "Strong Performer" (not Leader) status in Forrester's CCaaS Wave for 2025 (with noted enterprise WFM scalability gaps) present vulnerabilities. Kore.ai can emphasize its AI-native platform, predictable cost-per-outcome, and Leader status in CX-specific conversational AI evaluations. (2026-06-23) [Business Wire](#)

Salesforce Agentforce Secures New Enterprise Deployments Salesforce's Agentforce platform has announced new customer deployments, including VCARB for AI-powered fan engagement in Formula 1 and Petty Products for revenue management alongside Rootstock ERP. These wins demonstrate Agentforce's traction in applying AI agents across diverse enterprise functions. **Why it matters:** These customer wins validate the market demand for agentic AI. However, Agentforce's evolving and often complex consumption-based pricing model ("Flex Credits") and its prerequisite reliance on Data Cloud can lead to unpredictable costs and vendor lock-in for customers. Kore.ai can highlight its transparent pricing, open platform approach, and superior analyst validation in the conversational AI for CX category. (2026-06-23) [CX Today](#)

IBM and Google Cloud Partner for Production AI Agent Deployment IBM and Google Cloud have launched a joint practice focused on deploying production AI agents. This collaboration aims to help enterprises accelerate the adoption of agentic AI by leveraging the combined expertise and platforms of both companies. IBM also published thought leadership on the necessity of agentic orchestration over traditional chatbots. **Why it matters:** This partnership signals a significant push from two major tech players into the agentic AI deployment space, emphasizing the growing enterprise demand. However, IBM's recent slip to a Gartner Challenger in Conversational AI and reported internal platform overlaps (watsonx Orchestrate vs. watsonx Assistant) suggest potential complexity and a heavy reliance on consulting for successful deployments. Kore.ai can position its unified, Leader-recognized platform and ABL as a simpler, more deterministic path to production-grade agentic CX. (2026-06-22) [theaisoftwarereport.com](#)

Competitor Watch

Cresta Cresta is showcasing its AI Customer Experience Capabilities at CCW Las Vegas. This event provides a platform for Cresta to highlight its latest advancements in AI for contact centers. **Why it matters:** This confirms Cresta's continued focus on the CX market. While they are strong in conversation intelligence, Kore.ai's ABL offers superior compile-time validation and deterministic execution for complex enterprise agent flows, addressing Cresta's prompt-plus-custom-code build weaknesses. (2026-06-24) [TipRanks](#)

Five9 Five9 has launched a new release of Voice AI Agents, aiming to replace traditional IVRs and power next-generation agentic self-service. This strategic move is being highlighted across multiple business and tech publications. **Why it matters:** This is a significant product launch for Five9, directly competing in the AI agent space. However, it reinforces their challenge of bolting AI onto a legacy seat-based CCaaS model, which is vulnerable to AI deflection. Kore.ai's AI-native platform and predictable outcome-based pricing offer a stronger alternative for enterprises seeking scalable, cost-efficient, and governed AI automation. (2026-06-23) [Business Wire](#)

Glean Glean has partnered with TinyFish to enable AI agents to act on live web data within secure enterprise contexts. Additionally, Glean was recognized as a "Market Shaper" in the 2026 Gartner® Emerging Market Quadrant for No-Code Agent Builders - Startup Vendors. **Why it matters:** These developments show Glean's continued growth and recognition in the AI agent space. However, their focus remains primarily on *employee-facing* applications and internal knowledge management, not external customer-facing CX. Kore.ai should continue to differentiate by emphasizing its purpose-built, Leader-recognized platform for customer service. (2026-06-24) [Pluang](#), (2026-06-22) [Business Wire](#)

Sierra Sierra's enterprise CX agent platform was reviewed by Cybernews, and the company was included in Forbes' 2026 AI 50 List of top artificial intelligence companies. **Why it matters:** These items boost Sierra's visibility and brand recognition. However, they do not address the core competitive weakness of lacking independent Leader placement in CX-specific conversational AI analyst evaluations (like Gartner MQ or Forrester Wave for Customer Service), where Kore.ai holds a strong position. (2026-06-23) [Cybernews](#), (2026-06-23) [Forbes](#)

Parloa Parloa has released its "Consumer Patience Index," a study highlighting that poor automated customer service leads consumers to switch brands and that 1 in 3 Americans would rather switch brands than be put on hold. **Why it matters:** This positions Parloa as a thought leader on customer patience and automation risks. However, this self-published study does not address their significant gap in independent analyst validation for enterprise CX conversational AI, nor their limited geographic reach compared to Kore.ai's global enterprise presence and multiple Leader placements. (2026-06-22) [PR Newswire](#)

Genesys Nectar has expanded its Genesys Cloud observability with new operational intelligence capabilities, enhancing monitoring for Genesys Cloud deployments. **Why it matters:** This partnership helps Genesys customers with better visibility into their cloud operations, which could indirectly address some reliability concerns. However, it doesn't directly impact Genesys's core AI agent roadmap, its consumption-based AI token pricing unpredictability, or its relatively new GA status for more autonomous AI agents, all areas where Kore.ai offers differentiated strength. (2026-06-22) [Morningstar](#)

Platform & Big-Tech Moves

- (2026-06-23) **Salesforce Expands Formula 1 Push as VCARB Deploys Agentforce for AI-Powered Fan Engagement** — [CX Today](#)
- (2026-06-23) **Petty Products Goes Live on Rootstock ERP and Salesforce Agentforce Revenue Management to Drive Business Agility** — [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-06-23) **Cognizant Integrates ServiceNow AI Agents With Neuro AI Multi-Agent Accelerator** — [Yahoo Finance](#)
- (2026-06-23) **Nametag Deepens Partnership with ServiceNow to Protect Enterprise Helpdesks Against Impersonation Attacks** — [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-06-23) **Stop optimizing chatbots: Why customer care needs agentic orchestration - IBM** — [IBM](#)
- (2026-06-22) **IBM and Google Cloud Launch Joint Practice to Deploy Production AI Agents** — [theaisoftwarereport.com](#)

Analysts & Rankings

- (2026-06-22) **Glean Recognized as a Market Shaper in the 2026 Gartner® Emerging Market Quadrant for No-Code Agent Builders - Startup Vendors** — [Business Wire](#)

- **(2026-06-23) Forbes 2026 AI 50 List | Top Artificial Intelligence Companies (Sierra likely included)**
— [Forbes](#)

Funding, M&A & Industry

- **(2026-06-22) Kore.ai Review – Is It Worth the Price? - Cybernews** — [Cybernews](#)

Quick Hits

- **(2026-06-23) Sierra AI review: the enterprise CX agent platform explained** — [Cybernews](#)
- **(2026-06-23) Can Strategic Partnerships Help NOW Scale Enterprise AI Adoption?** — [The Globe and Mail](#)
- **(2026-06-22) Inspira Enterprise Expands to Full Suite of ServiceNow Platform Capabilities** — [PR Newswire](#)
- **(2026-06-22) Nectar Expands Genesys Cloud Observability with New Operational Intelligence Capabilities** — [Morningstar](#)